Center Midfields

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Player counts

In this project, there are a total of 182 center midfields considered, with

- 46 center midfields in 12 teams in the English FA Women's Super League
- 43 center midfields in 12 teams in the German Frauen Bundesliga
- 57 center midfields in 16 teams in the Spanish Liga F
- 36 center midfields in 10 teams in the Italian Serie A Women

Results

Results for 2 clusters

Breakdown of results by league

league	FA Women's Super League	Frauen Bundesliga	Liga F	Serie A Women
kmeans_2_cluster				
0	23	25	32	21
1	23	18	25	15

The split is rather more biased towards cluster 0, execpt for England Women's Super League where the split is equal.

Breakdown of results by features

- Cluster 0 shows more positiveness towards forward pass percentage, pass lengths, average shot distance, fouls won while defending, and pass more than carry when it comes to progression.
- On the other hand, positiveness in cluster 1 can be seen in positional metrics higher up the pitch, as they carry more than pass as a method of progression, while attempting more through balls and passes into the box.

Therefore, based on these results,

- Cluster 0 center midfielders can be seen as deep midfielders
- Cluster 1 center midfielders can be seen as advanced midfielders

Breakdown of results by players

Results for 3 clusters

Breakdown of results by league

league	FA Women's Super League	Frauen Bundesliga	Liga F	Serie A Women
kmeans_3_cluster				
0	14	7	15	7

league	FA Women's Super League	Frauen Bundesliga	Liga F	Serie A Women
kmeans_3_cluster				
1	11	17	16	12
2	21	19	26	17

Comparing results for 2 clusters against 3 clusters

kmeans_3_cluster	0	1	2
kmeans_2_cluster			
0	0	18	83
1	43	38	0

It seems like k = 3 cluster 1 is a shared zone between the two k = 2 clusters. Interestingly, no players from k = 2 cluster 0 landed in k = 3 cluster 0, while no players from k = 2 cluster 1 landed in k = 3 cluster 2.

Breakdown of results by features

- Cluster 0 midfielders passed more backward and shorter, while attempted more through balls in passes into opposition box. They carried forward more, and were active at higher areas up the pitch, including receiving and applying pressures and winning the ball.
- While for cluster 1, these midfielders attempted more passes forward and low and progressive into the final third, while receiving locations vary more. Passing is their main progression method.
- Cluster 2 midfielders, on the other hand, made longer passes and further shots, and were active at lower zones, especially shown in blocks in own box.

Hence, the following conclusions can be made:

- Similar to k = 2 cluster 0, k = 3 cluster 2 center midfields can be seen as deep pivot midfielders
- Similar to k = 2 cluster 1, k = 3 cluster 0 center midfields can be seen as advanced carrying midfielders
- Cluster 1 can be seen as progressive passing midfielders.

Further clustering of each type of midfielders (Defensive/Center/Attacking) will be done based on the results of k = 3 clusters.

The further clustering of each type is in its own file:

- Defensive midfielders (k = 3 cluster 2)
- Center midfielders (k = 3 cluster 1)
- Attacking midfielders (k = 3 cluster 0)

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Appendix

Radar plots for 2 clusters center midfields' averages

All leagues

Passing

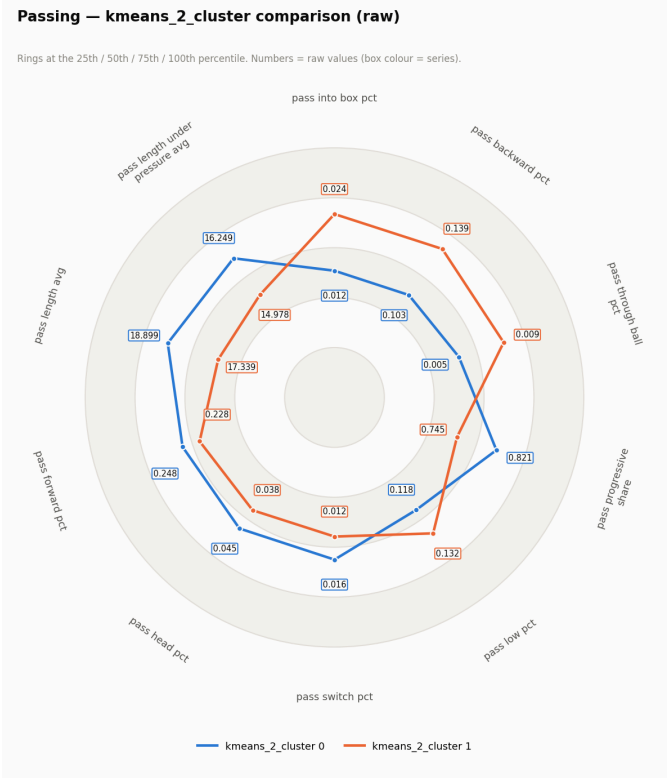


Figure 1: Center Midfields Passing — Raw Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

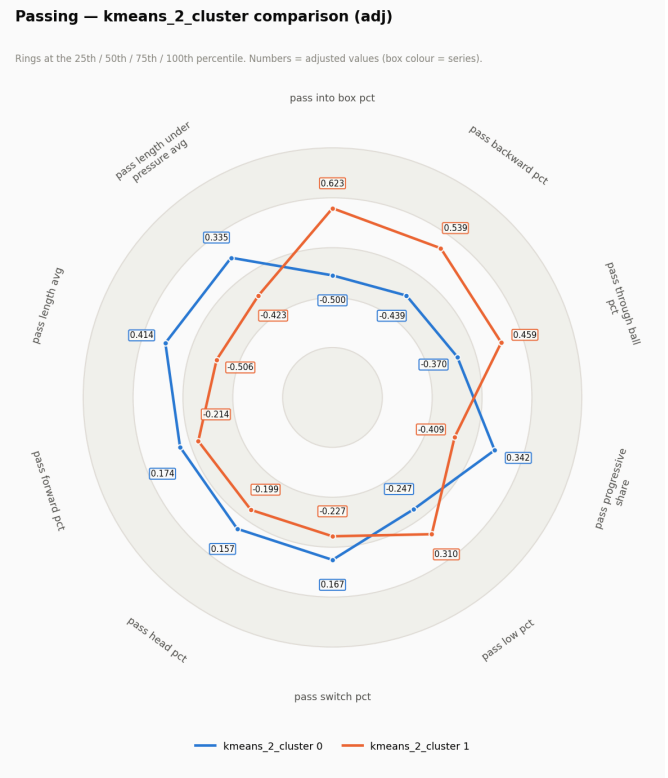


Figure 2: Center Midfields Passing — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

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Carrying, Receipt, Dribbling & Shooting

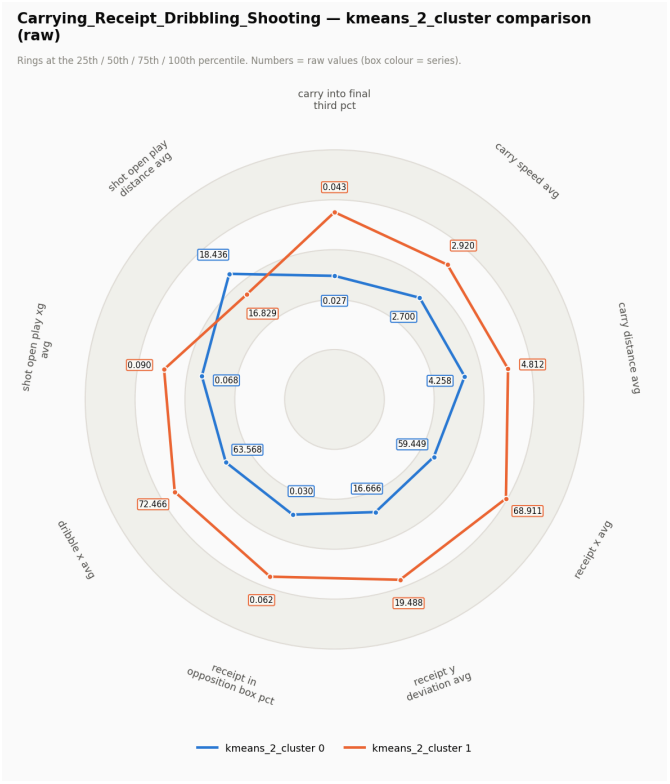


Figure 3: Center Midfields Carrying, Receipt, Dribbling & Shooting — Raw Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

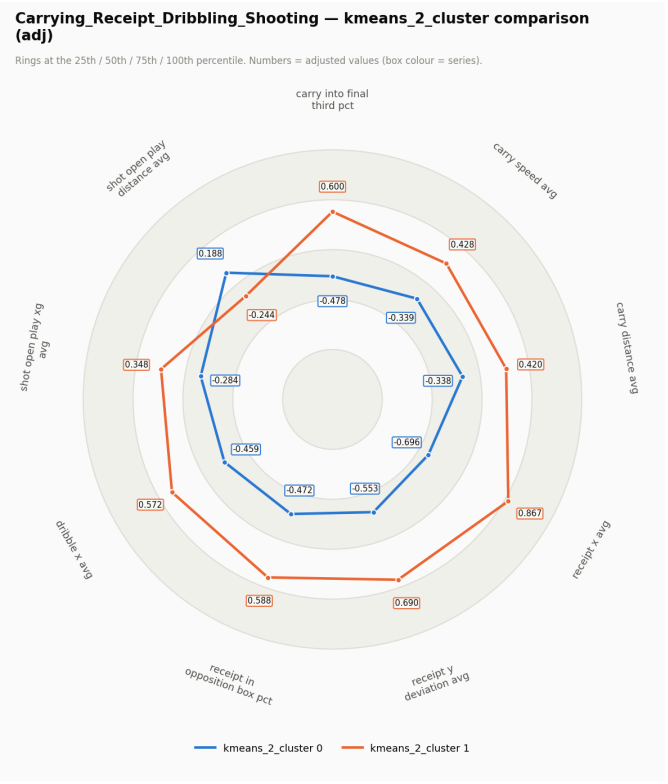


Figure 4: Center Midfields Carrying, Receipt, Dribbling & Shooting — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

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Defending & Vulnerability

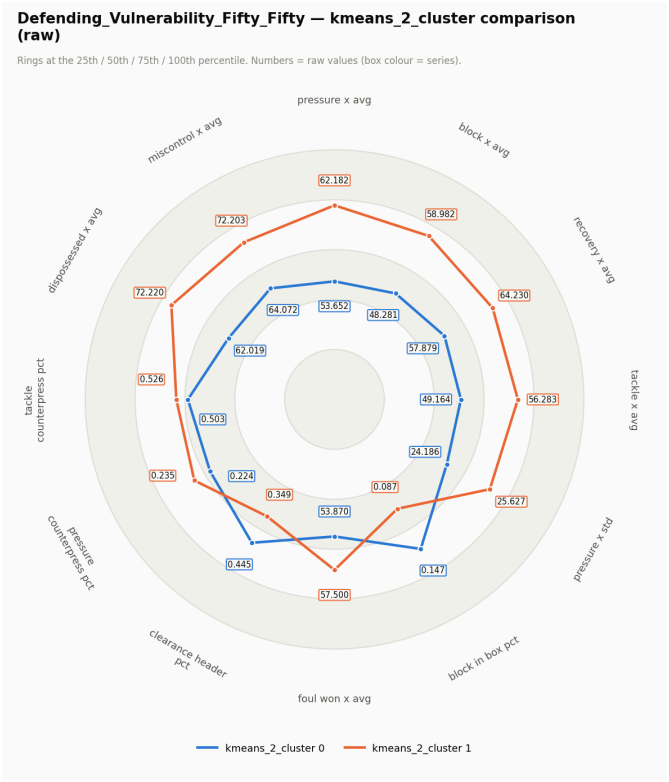


Figure 5: Center Midfields Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Raw Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

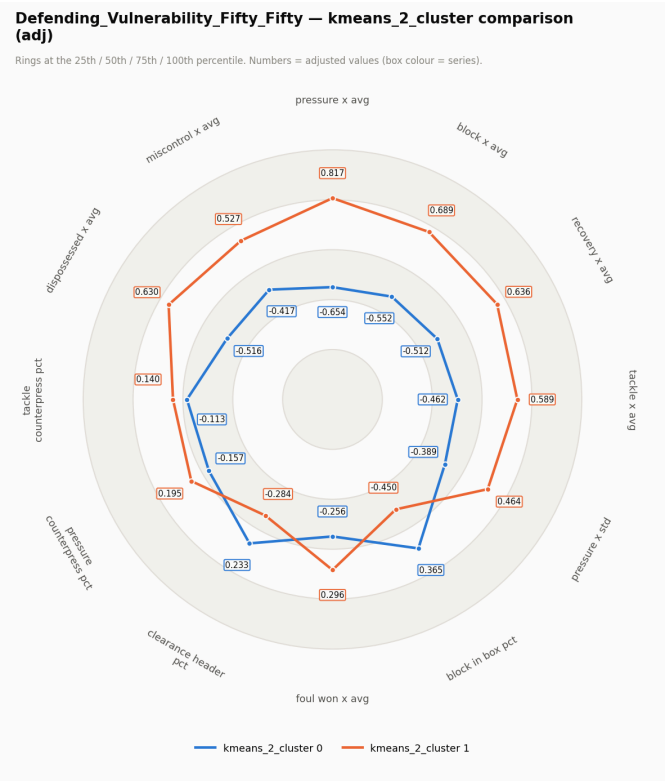


Figure 6: Center Midfields Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

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FA Women's Super League

Passing

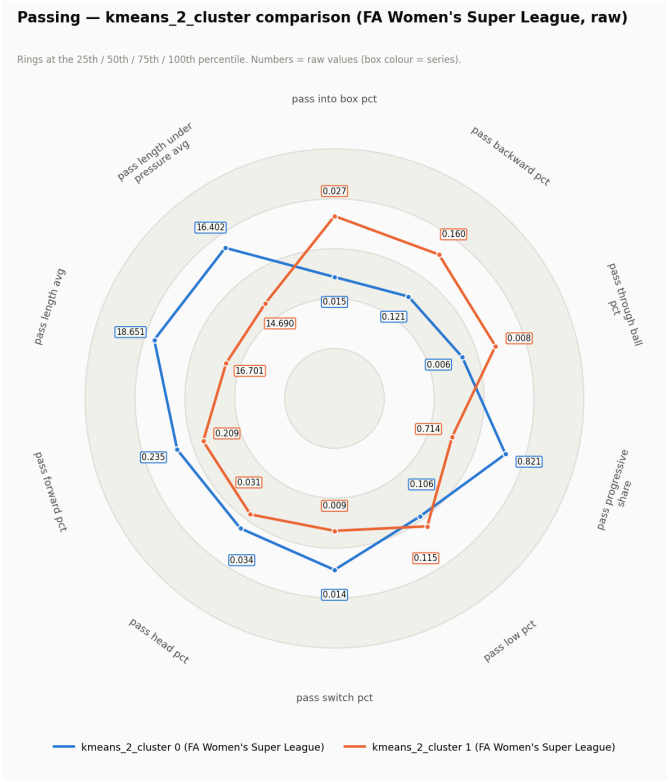


Figure 7: England Center Midfields Passing — Raw Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

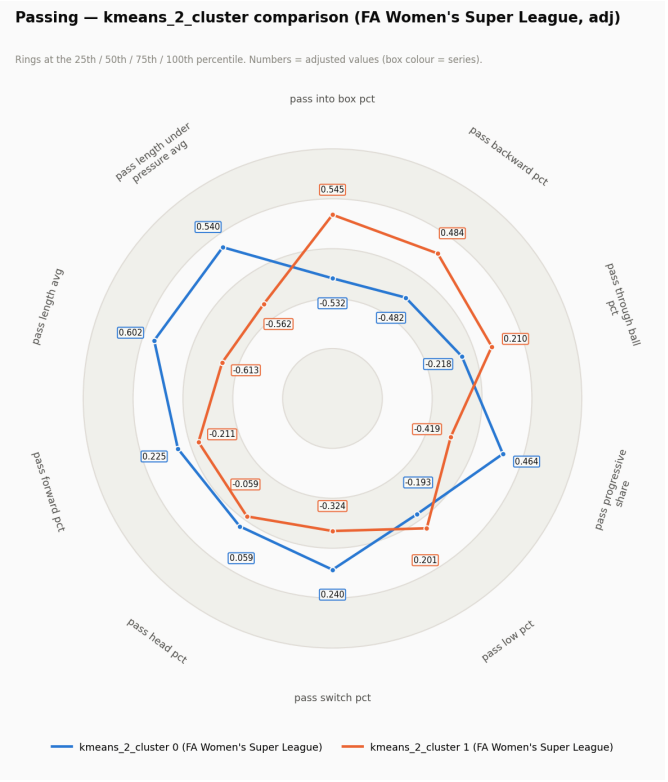


Figure 8: England Center Midfields Passing — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

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Carrying, Receipt, Dribbling & Shooting

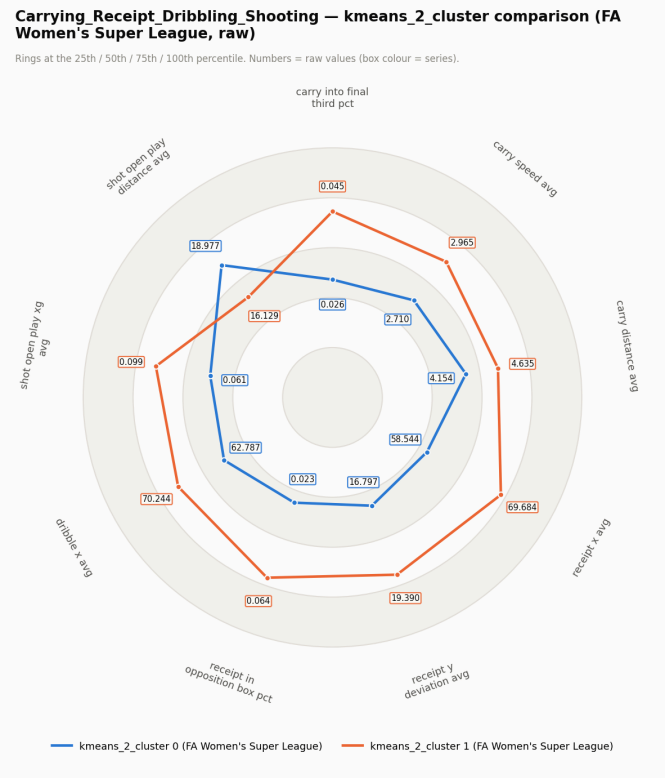


Figure 9: England Center Midfields Carrying, Receipt, Dribbling & Shooting — Raw Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

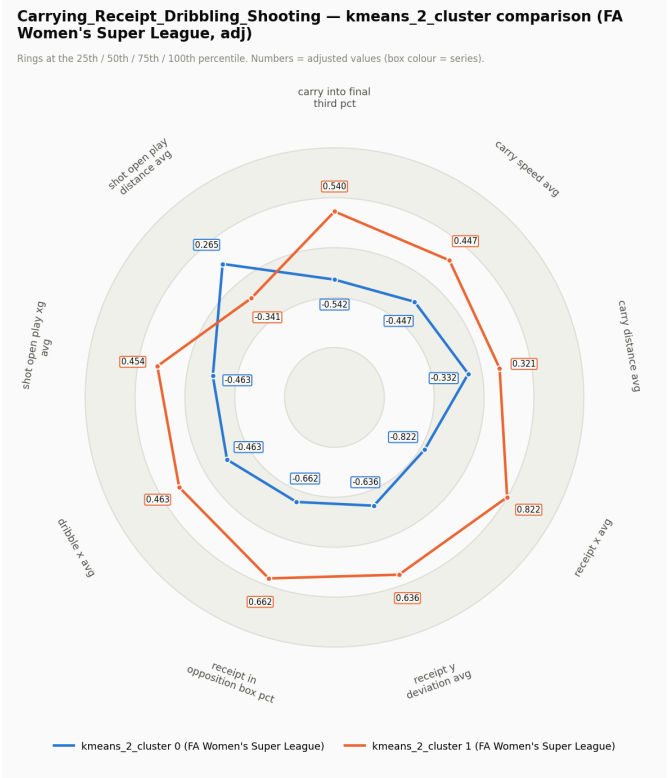


Figure 10: England Center Midfields Carrying, Receipt, Dribbling & Shooting — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

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Defending & Vulnerability

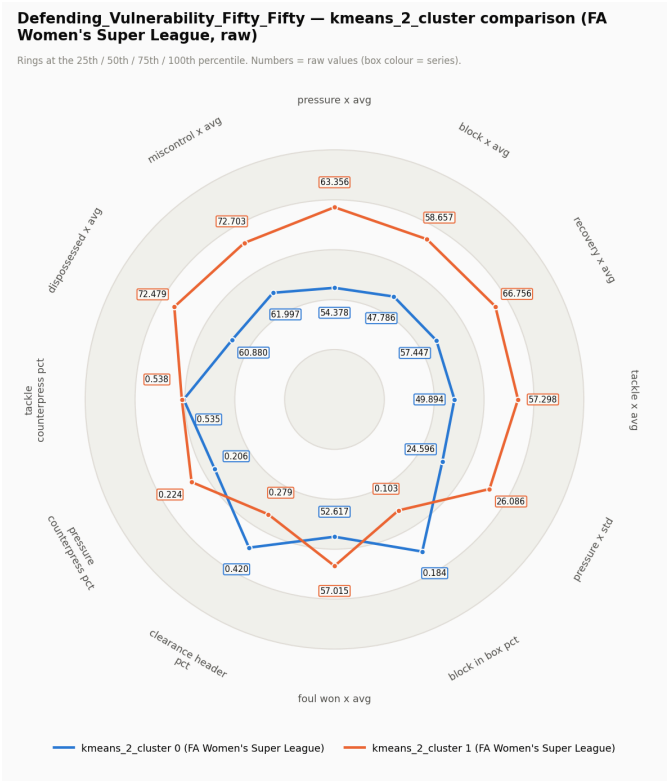


Figure 11: England Center Midfields Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Raw Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

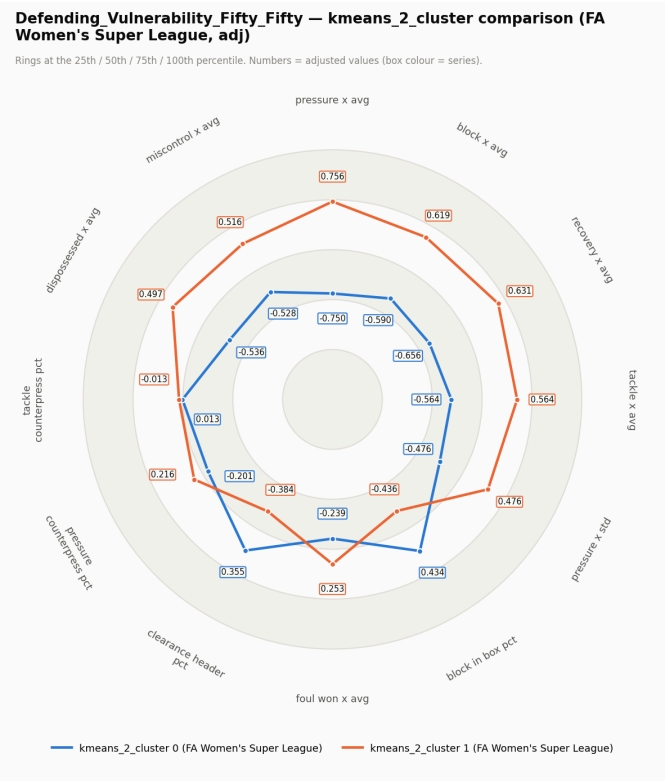


Figure 12: England Center Midfields Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

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Frauen Bundesliga

Passing

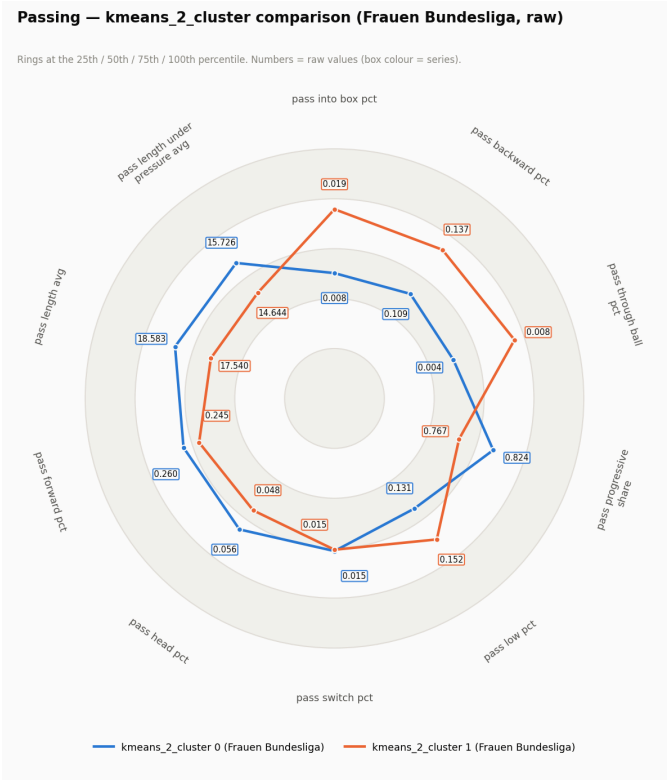


Figure 13: Germany Center Midfields Passing — Raw Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

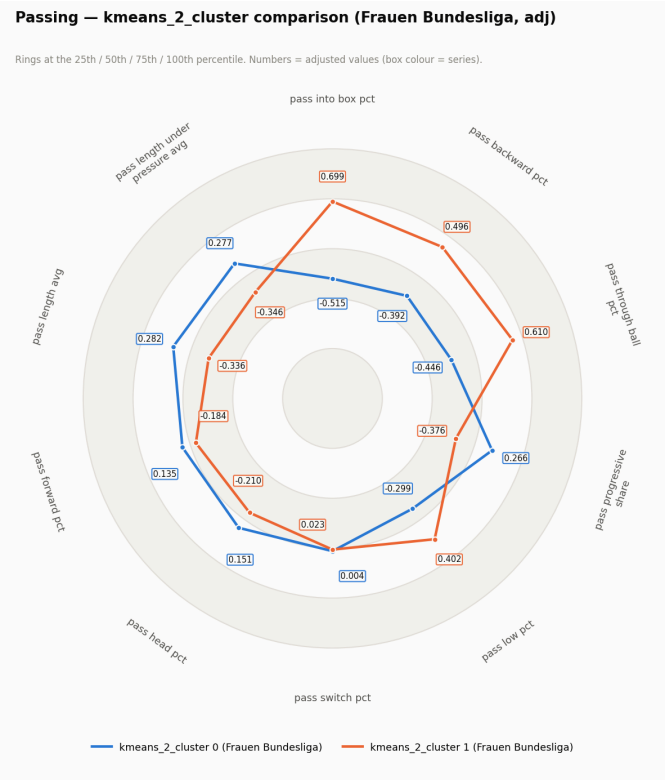


Figure 14: Germany Center Midfields Passing — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

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Carrying, Receipt, Dribbling & Shooting

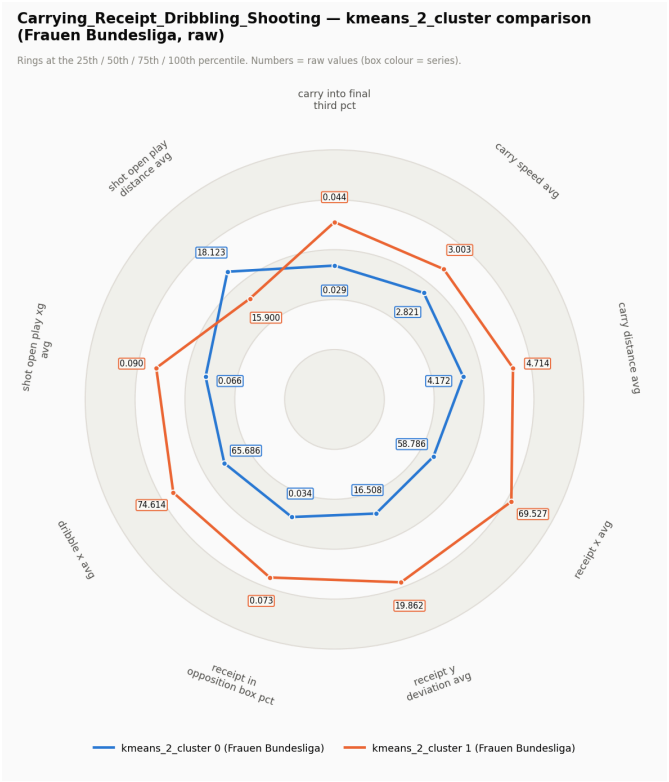


Figure 15: Germany Center Midfields Carrying, Receipt, Dribbling & Shooting — Raw Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

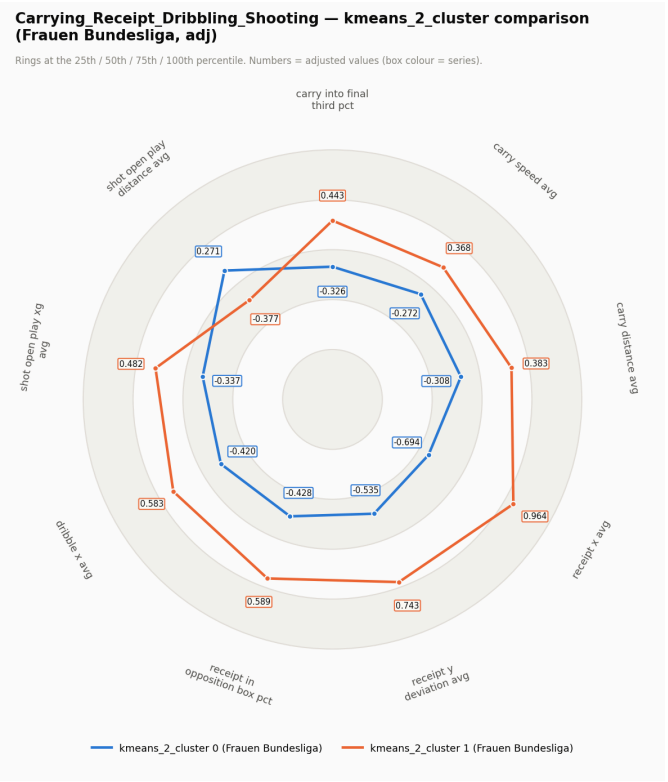


Figure 16: Germany Center Midfields Carrying, Receipt, Dribbling & Shooting — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

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Defending & Vulnerability

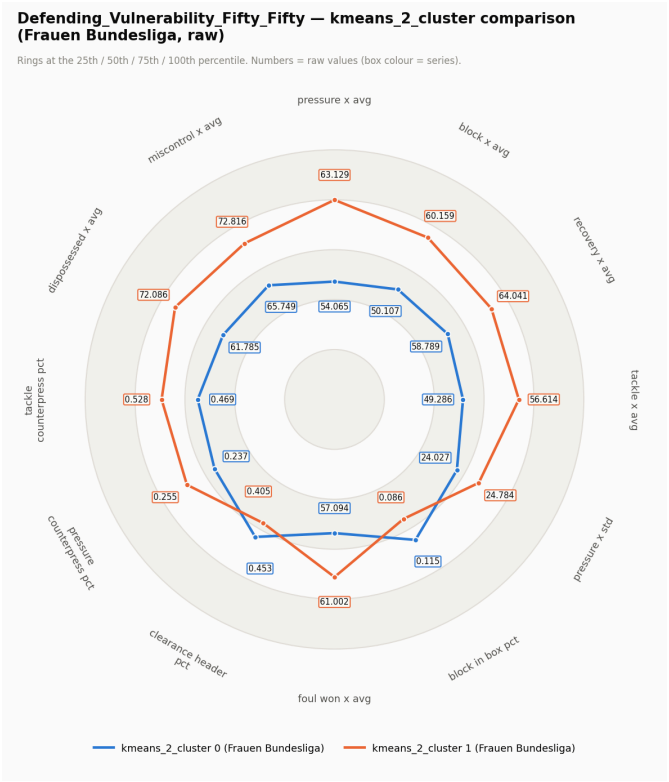


Figure 17: Germany Center Midfields Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Raw Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

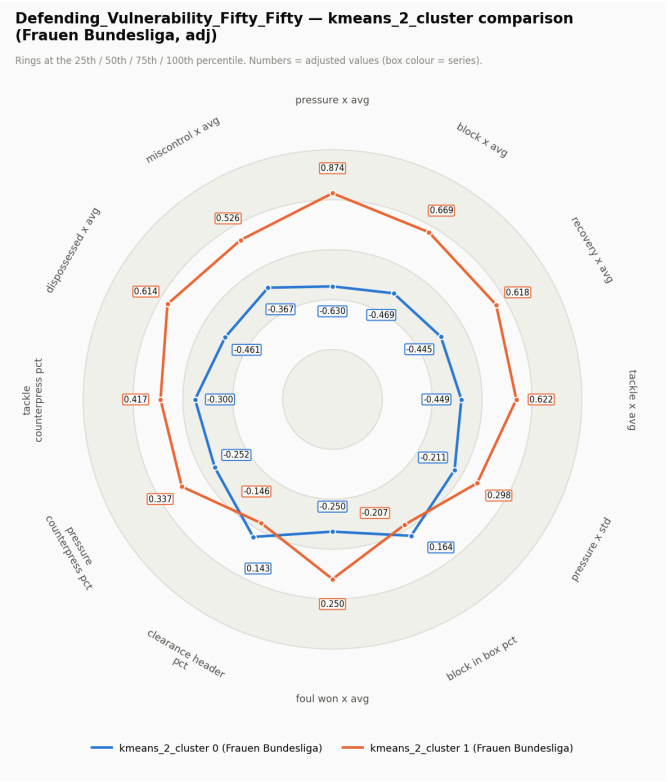


Figure 18: Germany Center Midfields Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

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Liga F

Passing

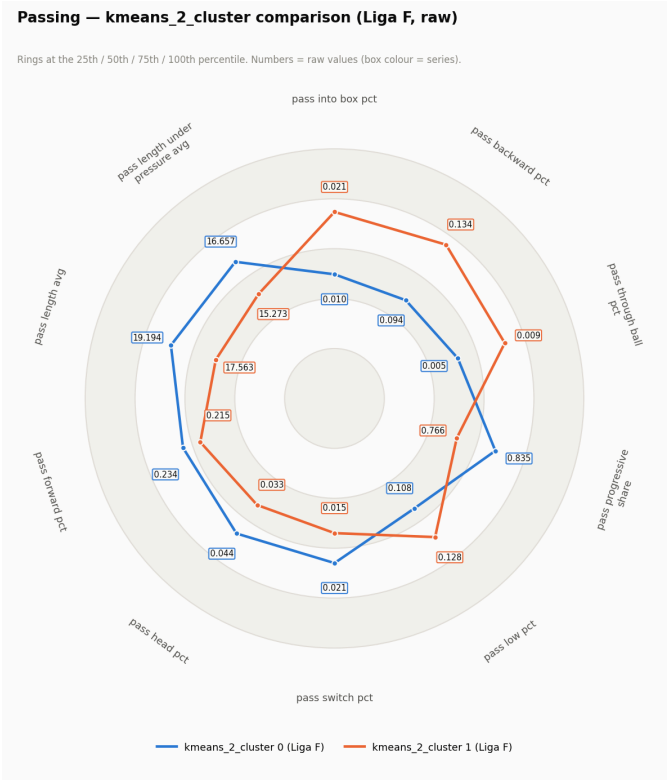


Figure 19: Spain Center Midfields Passing — Raw Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

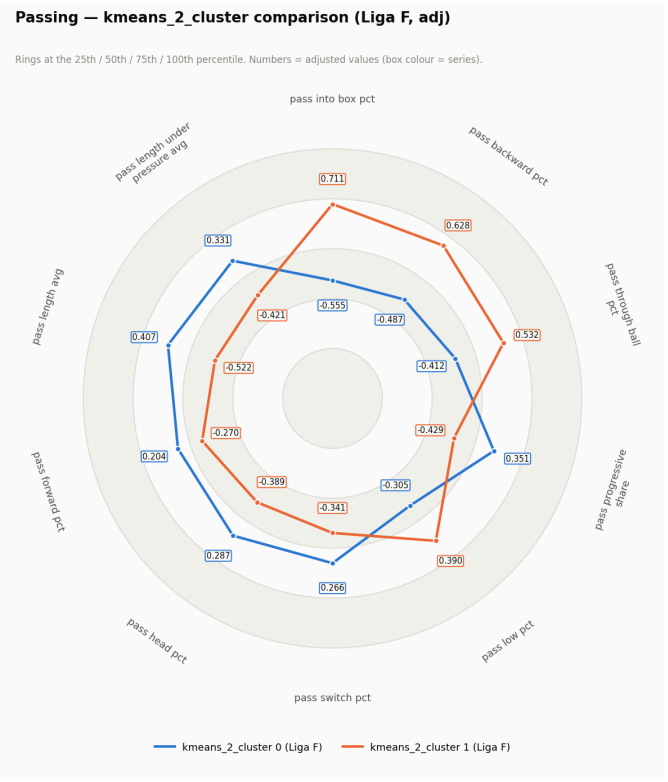


Figure 20: Spain Center Midfields Passing — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

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Carrying, Receipt, Dribbling & Shooting

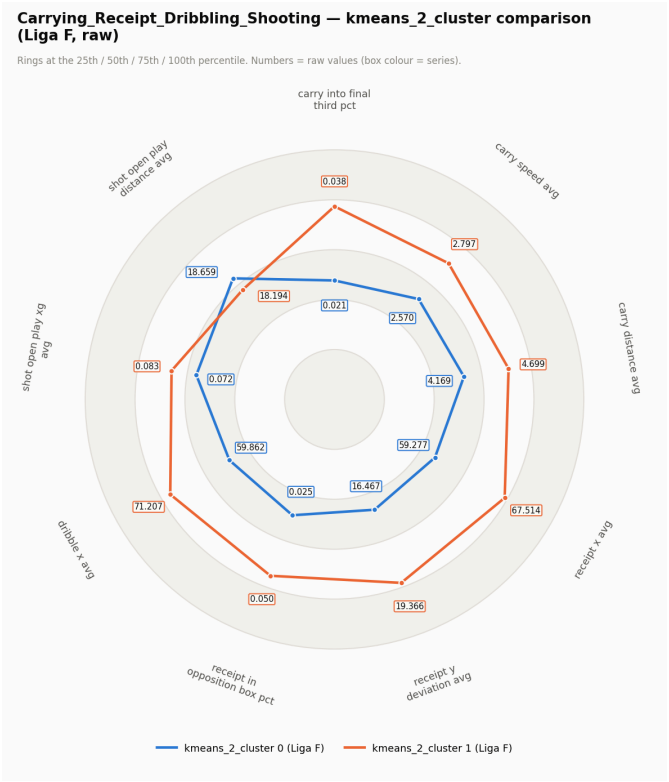


Figure 21: Spain Center Midfields Carrying, Receipt, Dribbling & Shooting — Raw Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

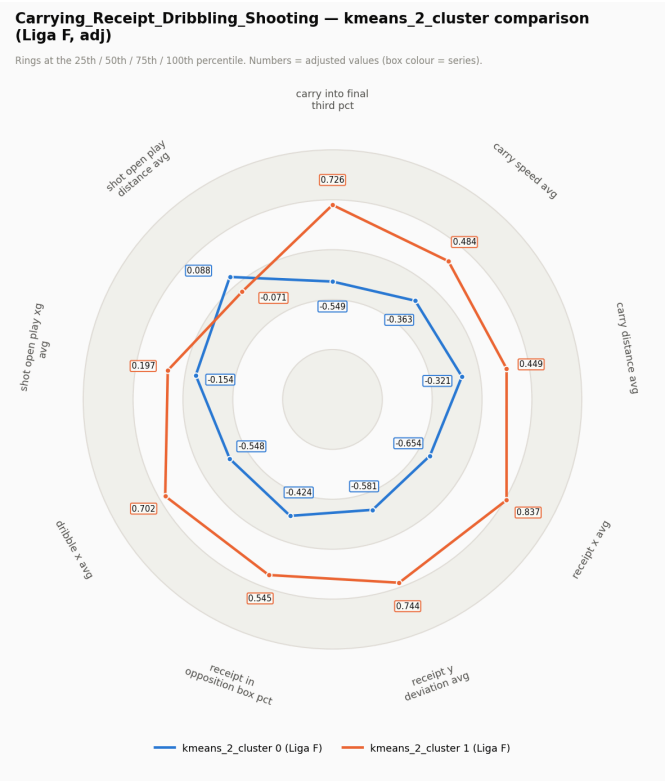


Figure 22: Spain Center Midfields Carrying, Receipt, Dribbling & Shooting — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

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Defending & Vulnerability

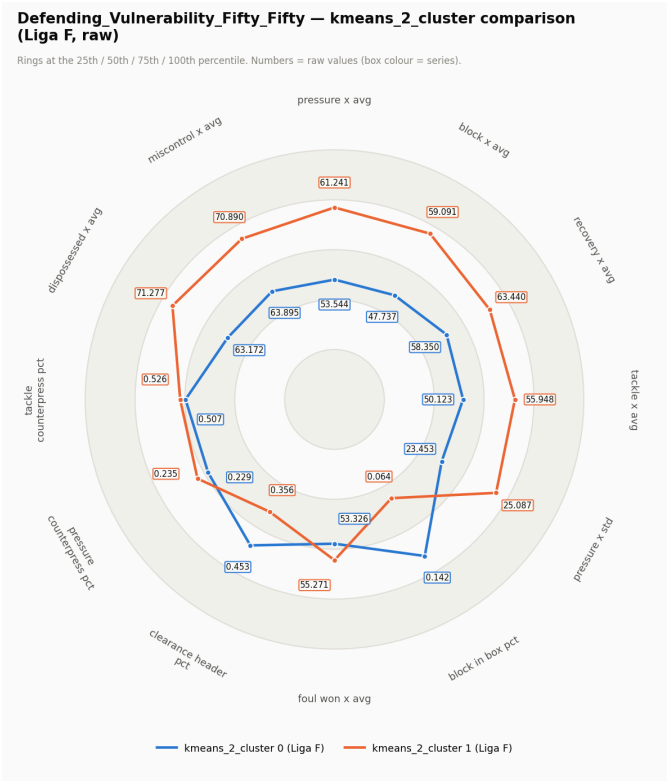


Figure 23: Spain Center Midfields Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Raw Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

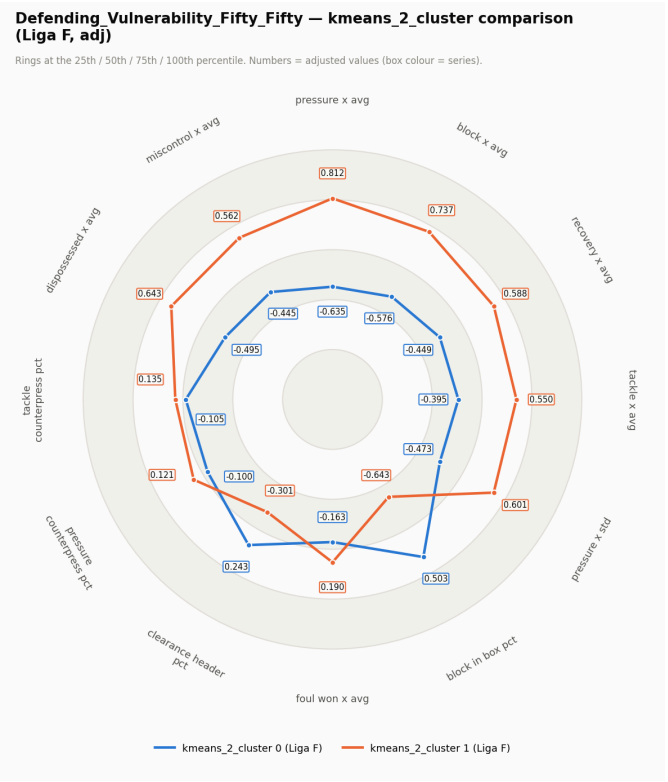


Figure 24: Spain Center Midfields Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

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Serie A Women

Passing

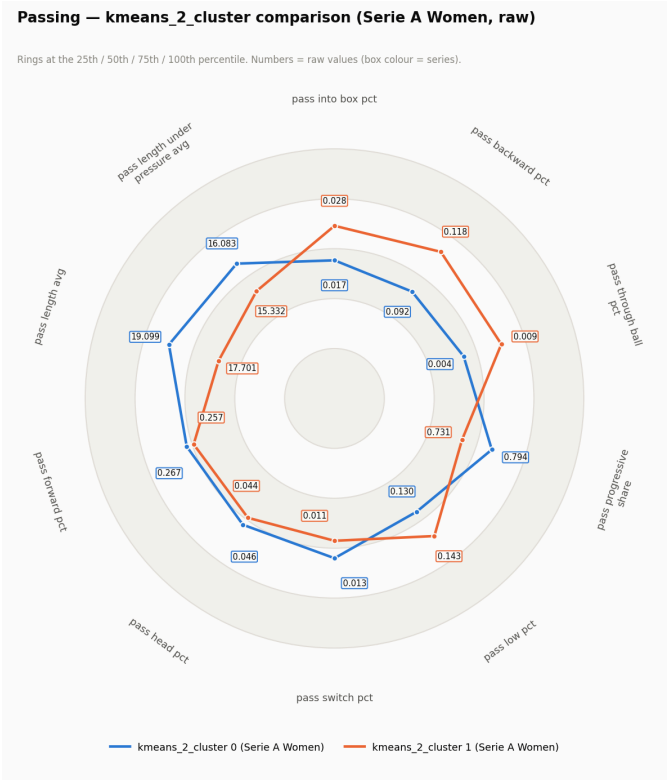


Figure 25: Italy Center Midfields Passing — Raw Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

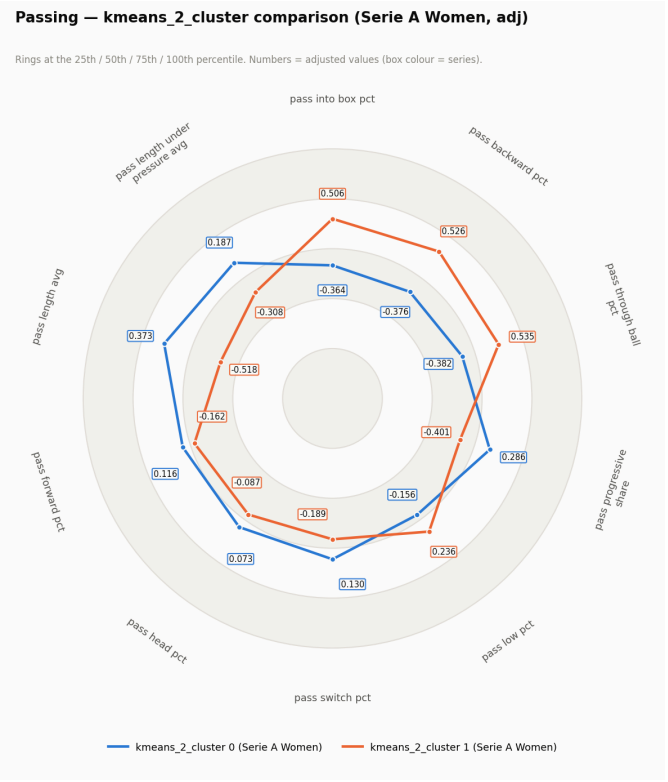


Figure 26: Italy Center Midfields Passing — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

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Carrying, Receipt, Dribbling & Shooting

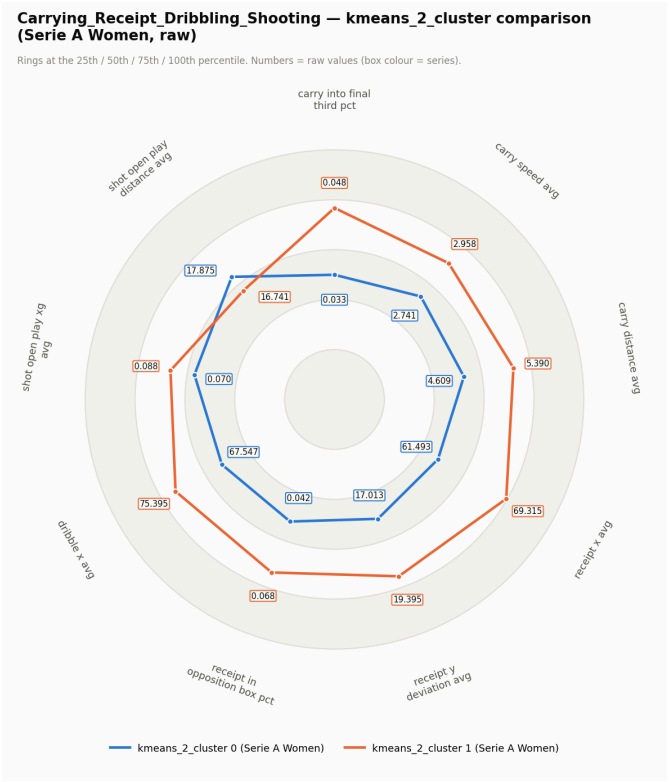


Figure 27: Italy Center Midfields Carrying, Receipt, Dribbling & Shooting — Raw Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

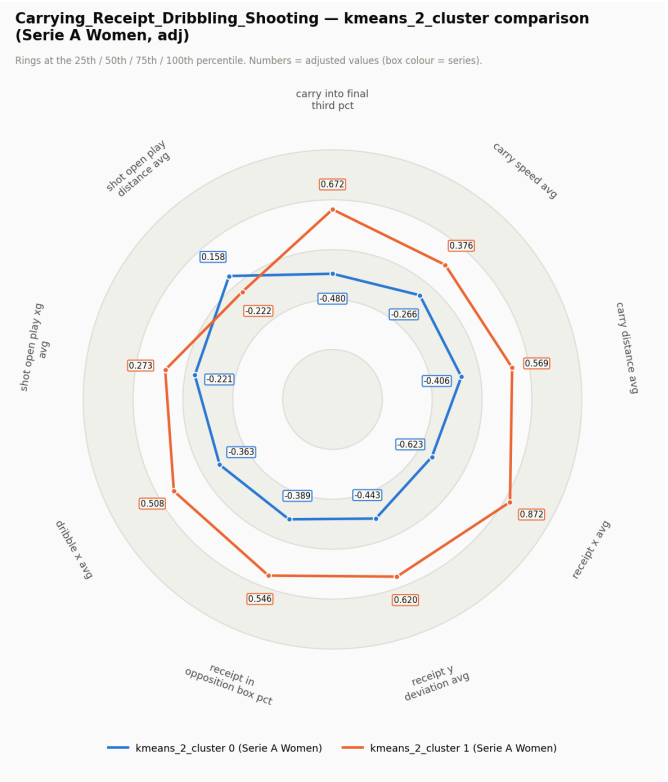


Figure 28: Italy Center Midfields Carrying, Receipt, Dribbling & Shooting — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

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Defending & Vulnerability

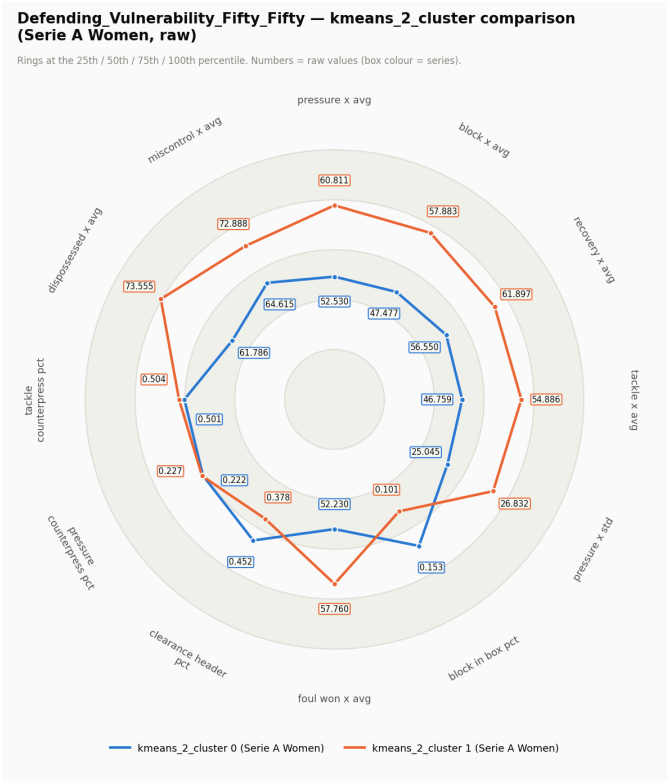


Figure 29: Italy Center Midfields Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Raw Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

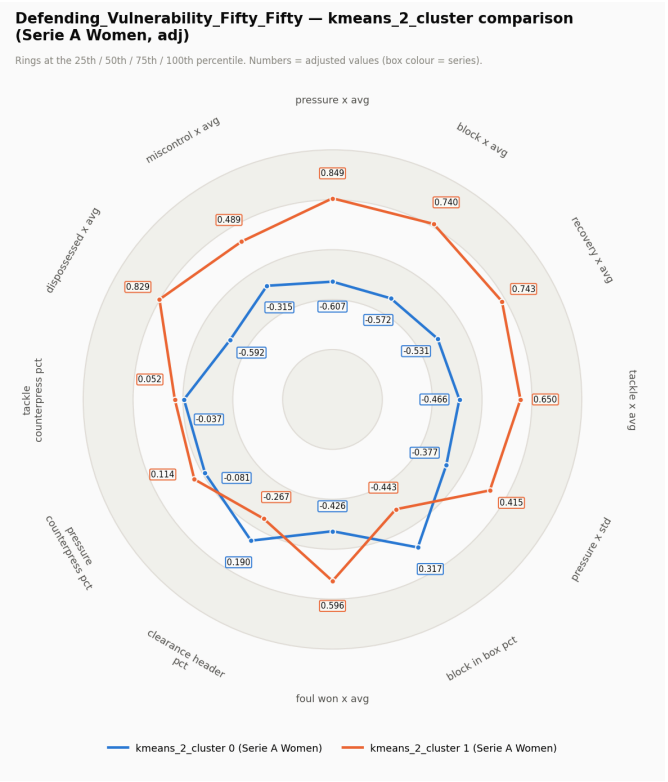


Figure 30: Italy Center Midfields Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

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Radar plots for 3 clusters center midfields' averages

All leagues

Passing

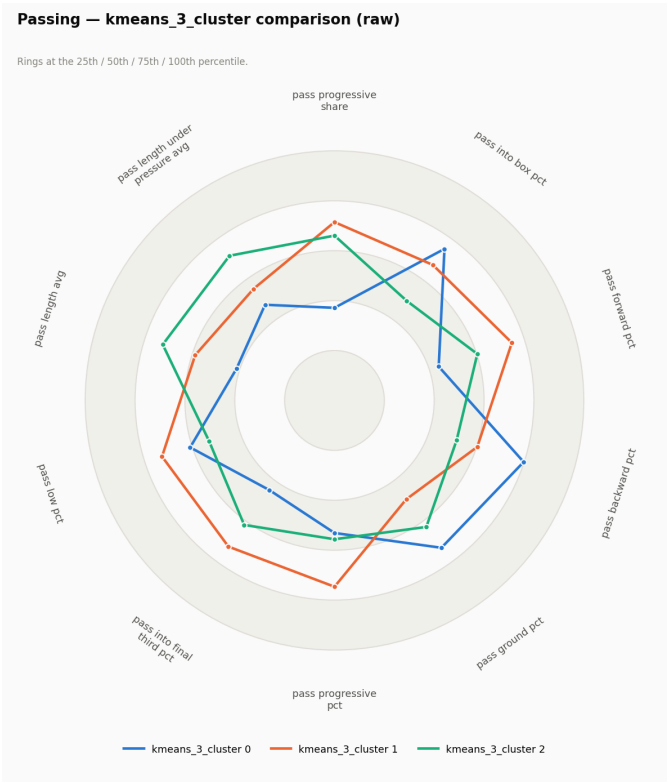


Figure 31: Center Midfields Passing — Raw Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

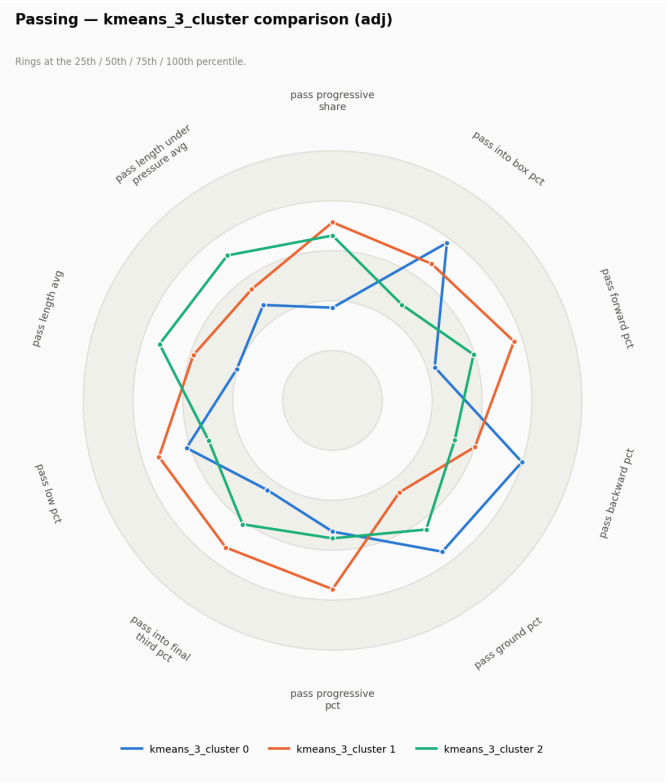


Figure 32: Center Midfields Passing — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

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Carrying, Receipt, Dribbling & Shooting

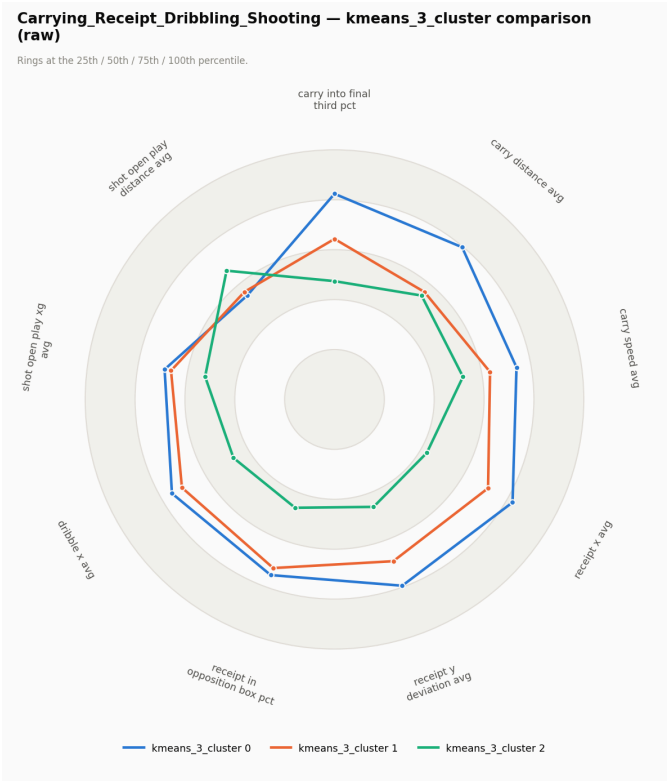


Figure 33: Center Midfields Carrying, Receipt, Dribbling & Shooting — Raw Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

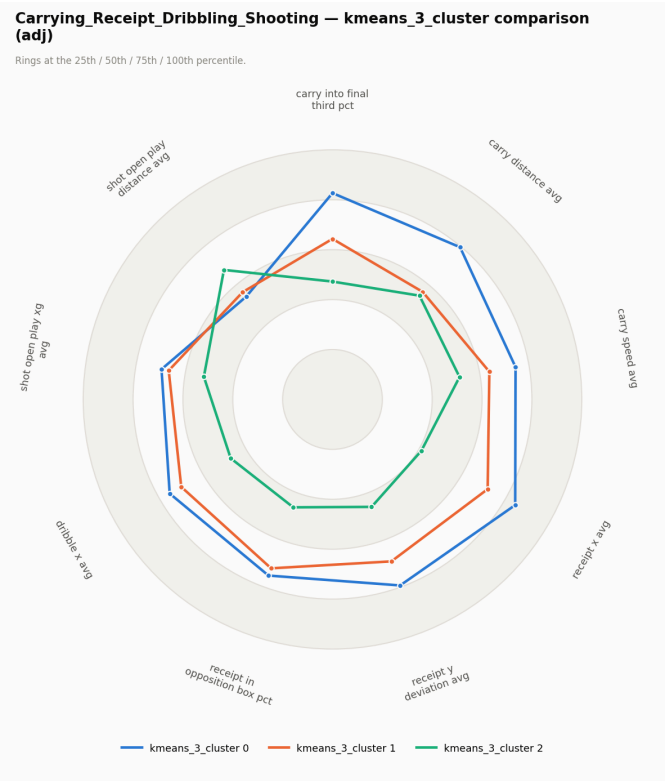


Figure 34: Center Midfields Carrying, Receipt, Dribbling & Shooting — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

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Defending & Vulnerability

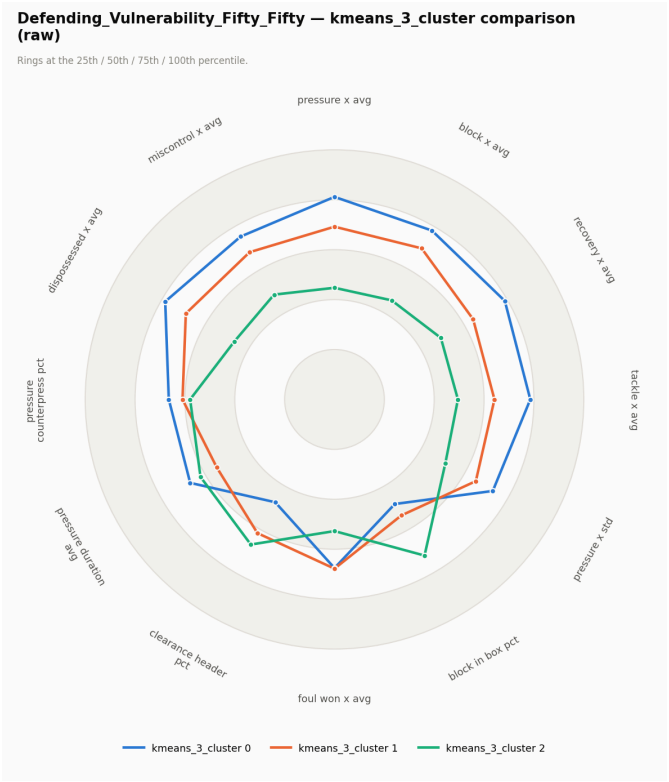


Figure 35: Center Midfields Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Raw Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

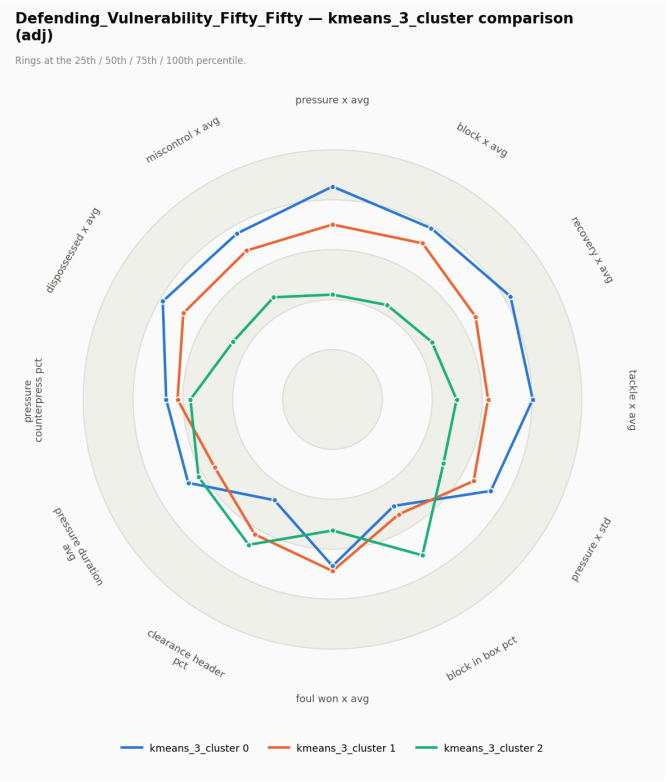


Figure 36: Center Midfields Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

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FA Women's Super League

Passing

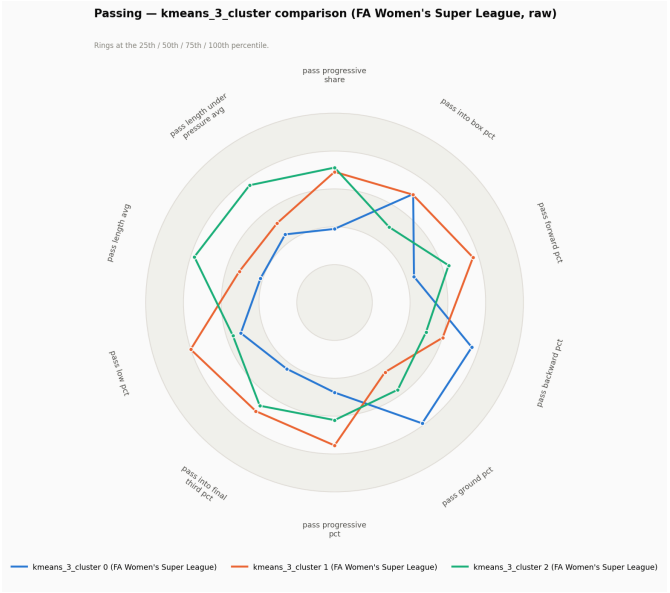


Figure 37: England Center Midfields Passing — Raw Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

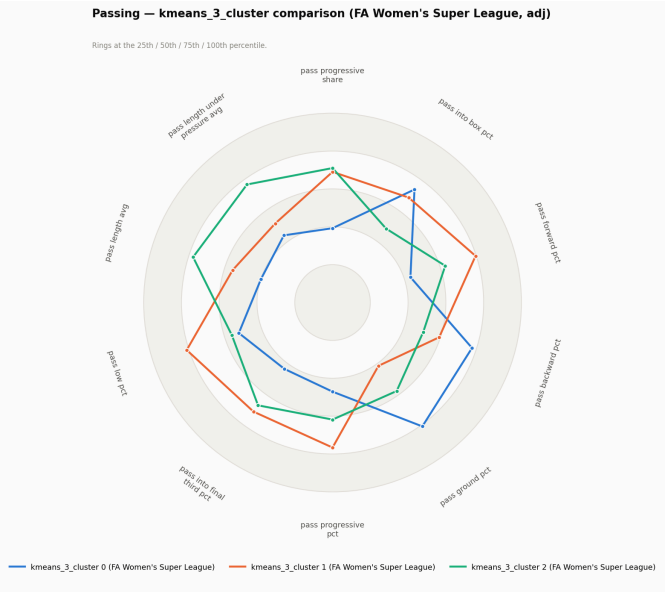


Figure 38: England Center Midfields Passing — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

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Carrying, Receipt, Dribbling & Shooting

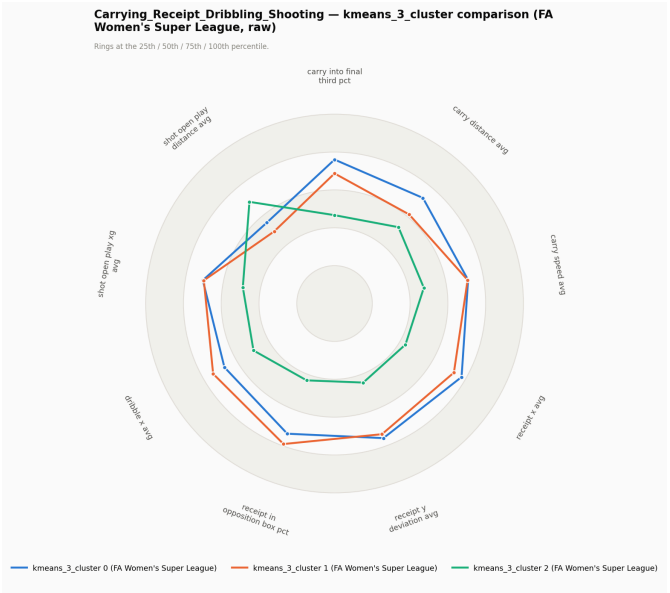


Figure 39: England Center Midfields Carrying, Receipt, Dribbling & Shooting — Raw Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

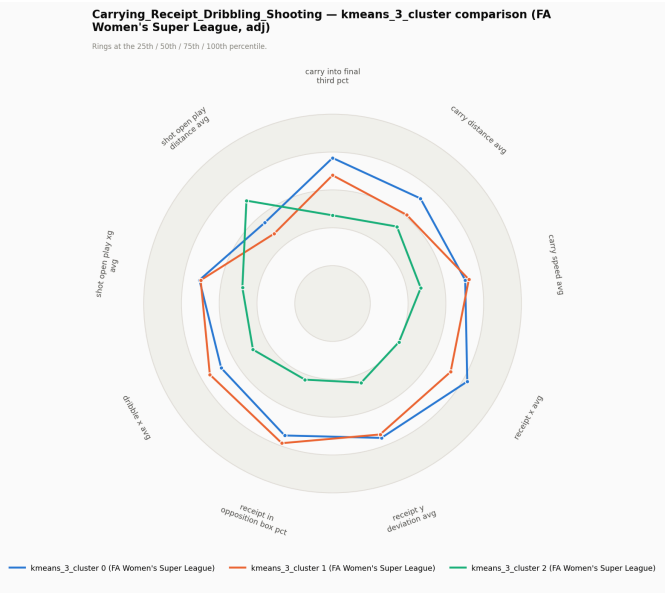


Figure 40: England Center Midfields Carrying, Receipt, Dribbling & Shooting — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

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Defending & Vulnerability

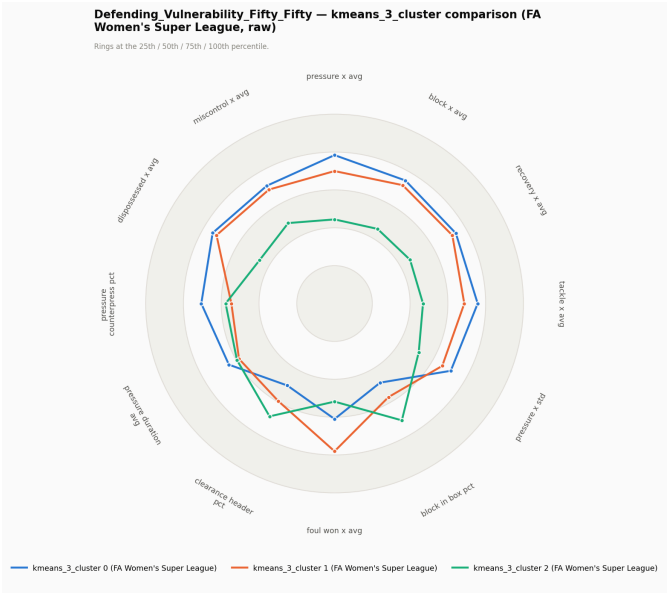


Figure 41: England Center Midfields Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Raw Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

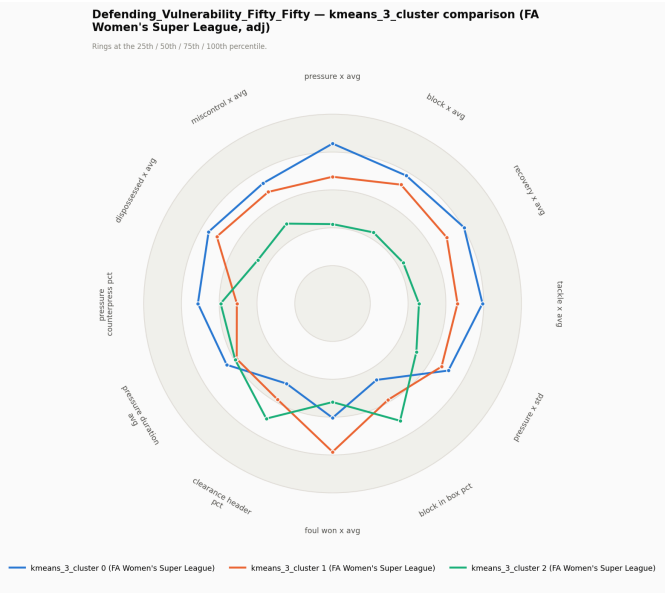


Figure 42: England Center Midfields Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

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Frauen Bundesliga

Passing

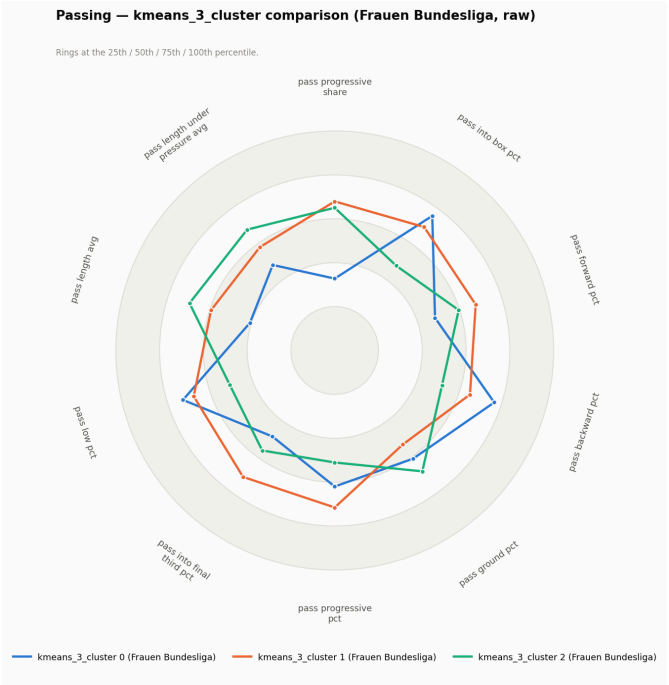


Figure 43: Germany Center Midfields Passing — Raw Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

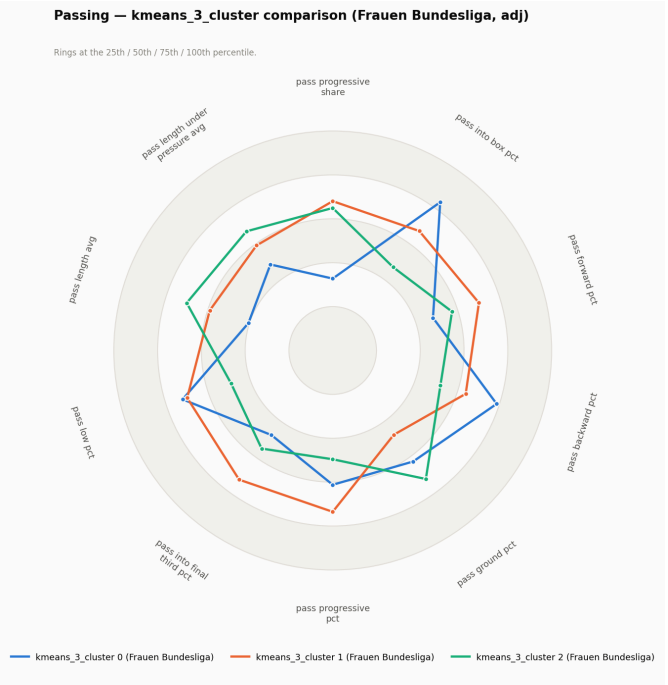


Figure 44: Germany Center Midfields Passing — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

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Carrying, Receipt, Dribbling & Shooting

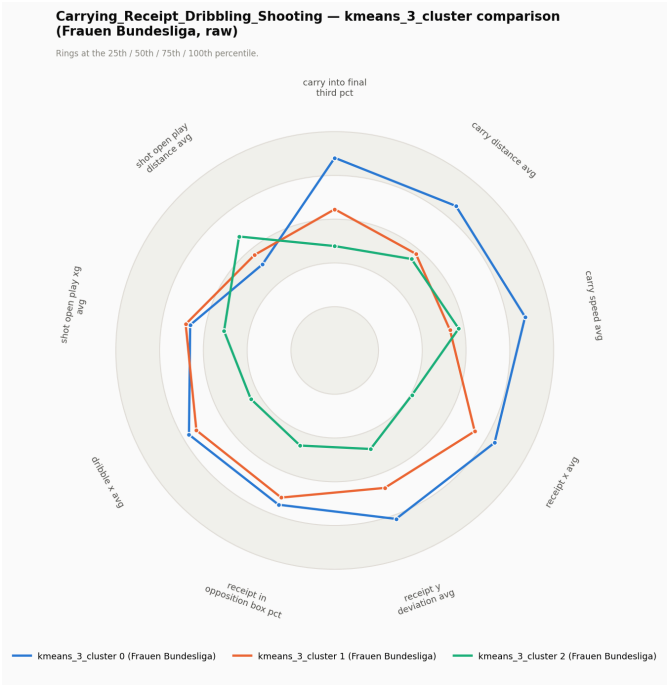


Figure 45: Germany Center Midfields Carrying, Receipt, Dribbling & Shooting — Raw Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

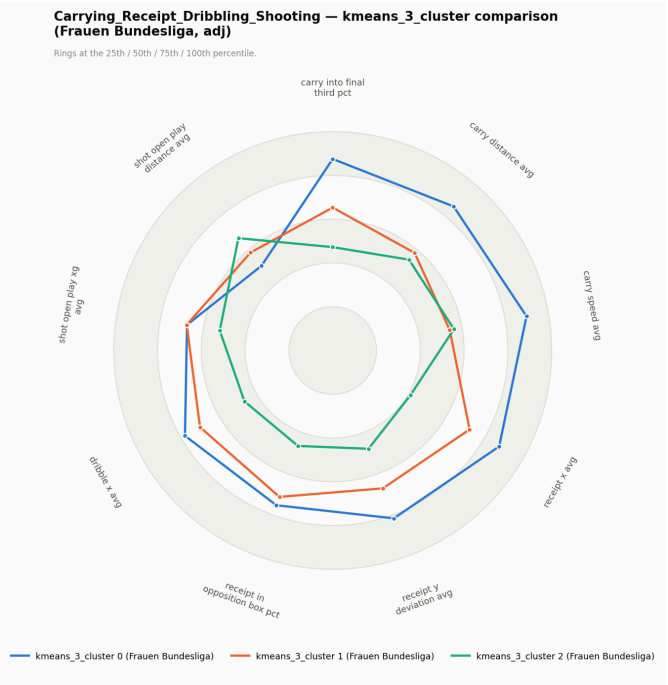


Figure 46: Germany Center Midfields Carrying, Receipt, Dribbling & Shooting — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

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Defending & Vulnerability

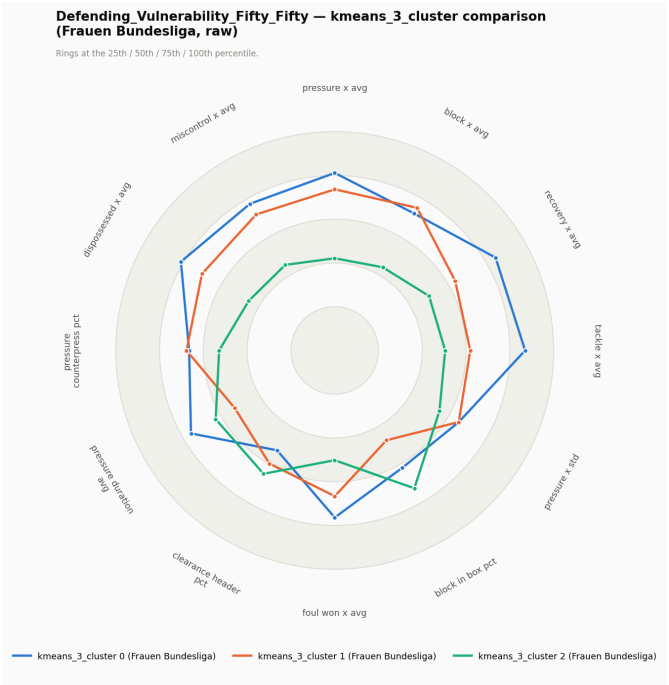


Figure 47: Germany Center Midfields Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Raw Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

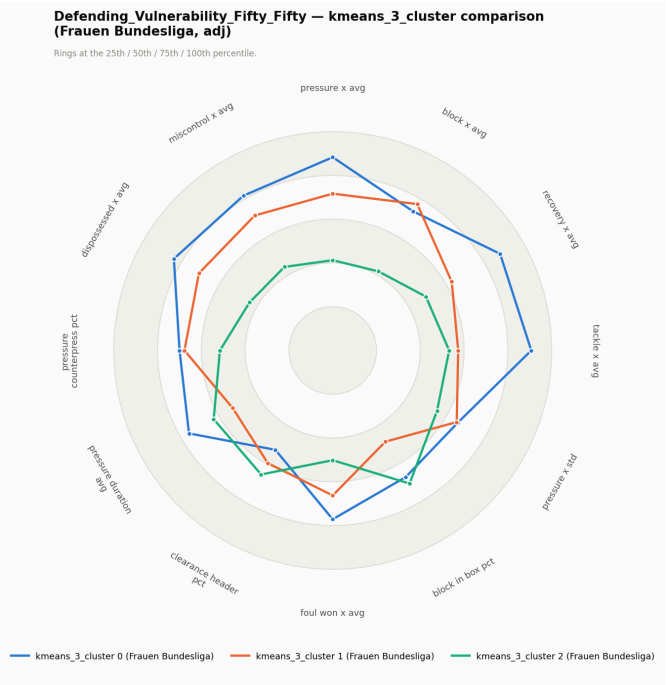


Figure 48: Germany Center Midfields Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

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Liga F

Passing

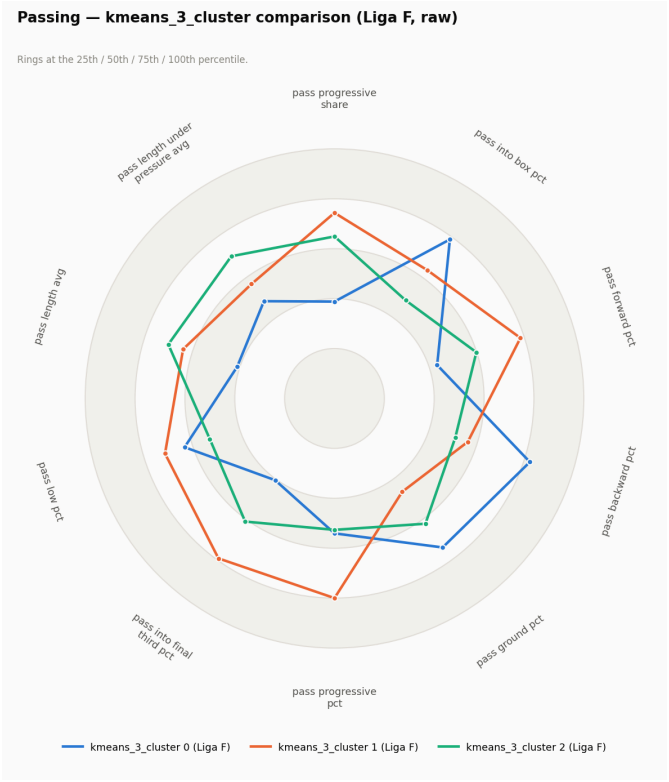


Figure 49: Spain Center Midfields Passing — Raw Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

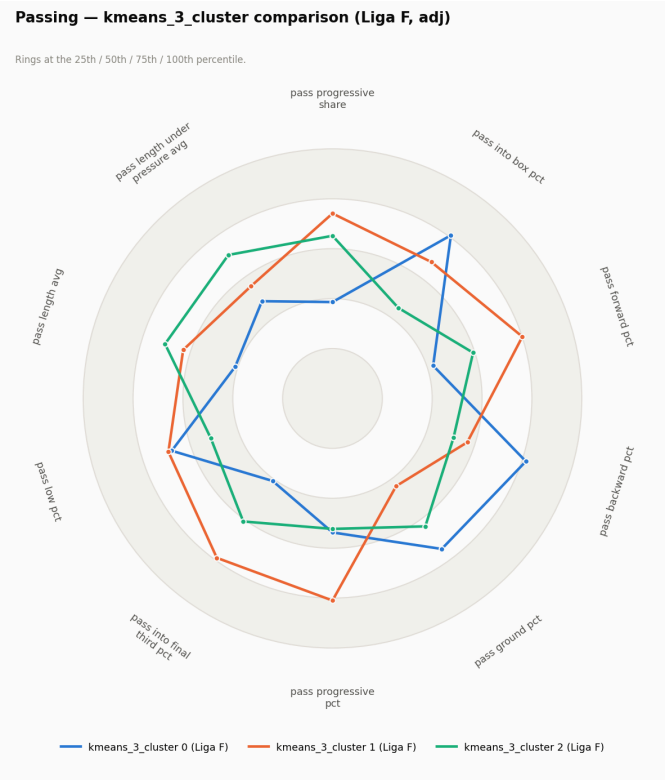


Figure 50: Spain Center Midfields Passing — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

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Carrying, Receipt, Dribbling & Shooting

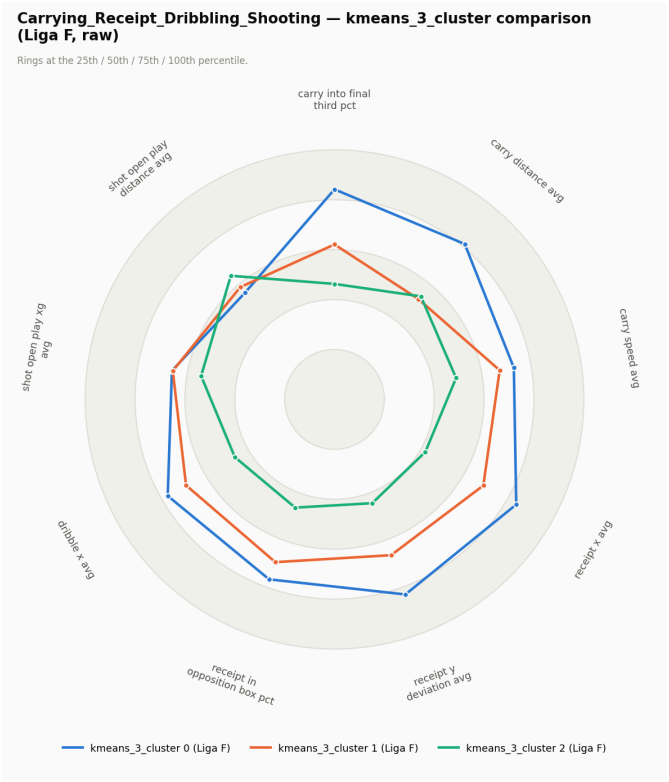


Figure 51: Spain Center Midfields Carrying, Receipt, Dribbling & Shooting — Raw Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

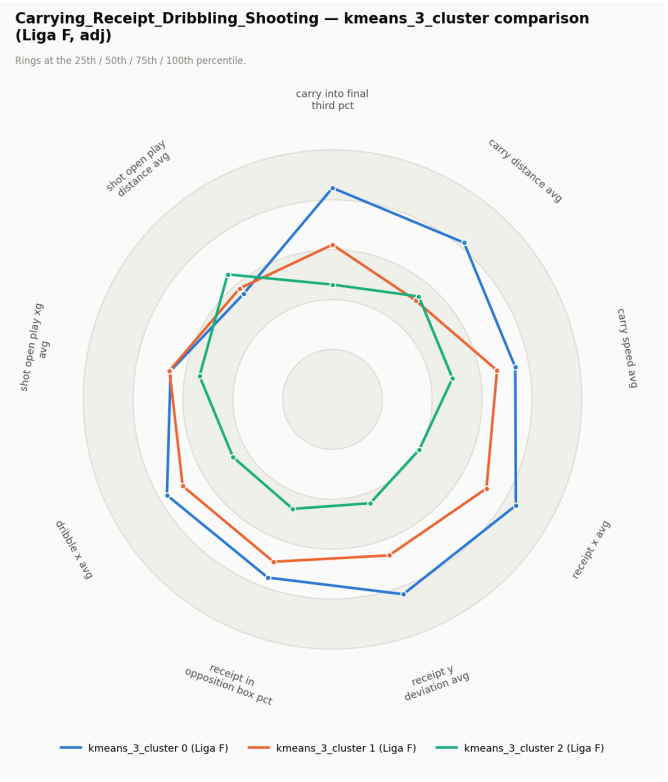


Figure 52: Spain Center Midfields Carrying, Receipt, Dribbling & Shooting — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

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Defending & Vulnerability

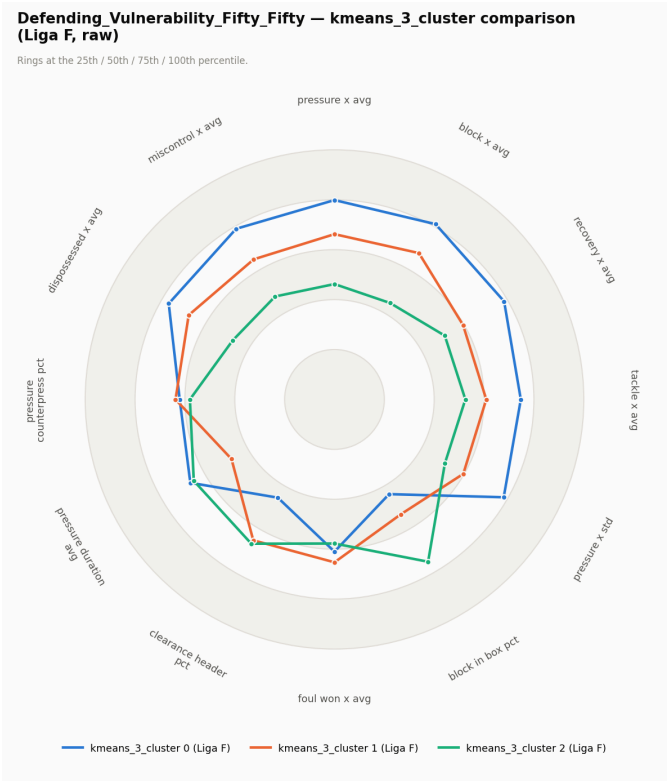


Figure 53: Spain Center Midfields Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Raw Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

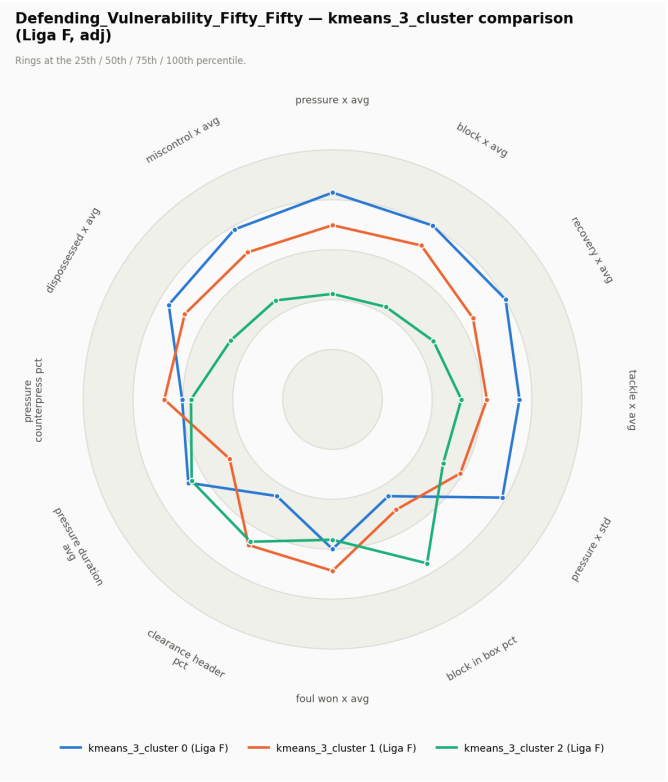


Figure 54: Spain Center Midfields Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

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Serie A Women

Passing

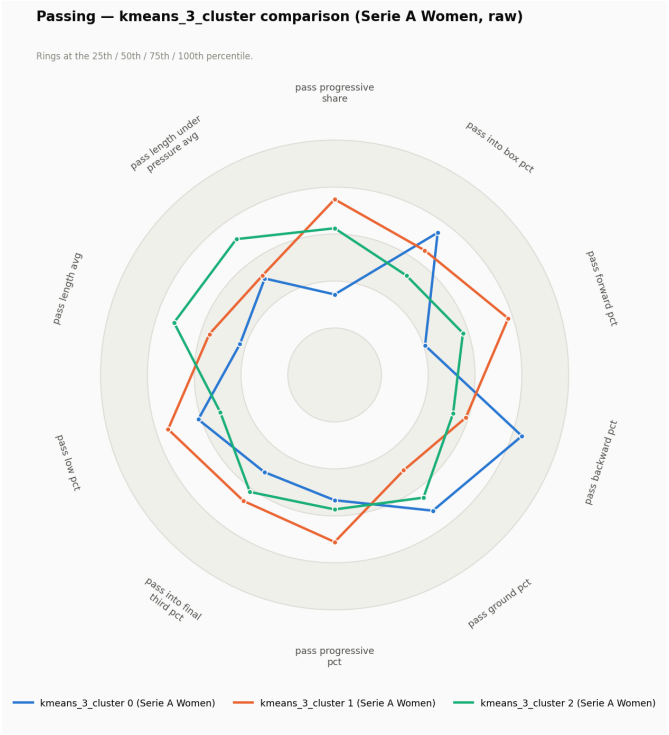


Figure 55: Italy Center Midfields Passing — Raw Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

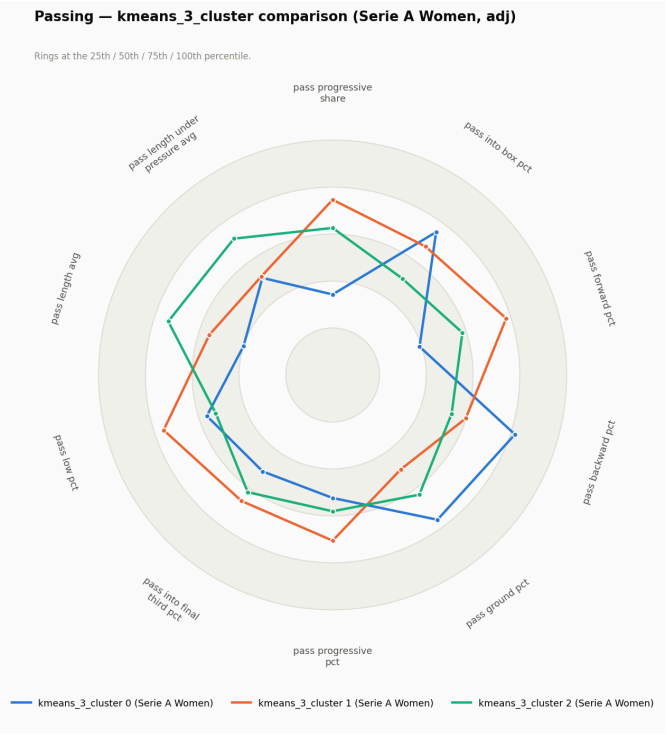


Figure 56: Italy Center Midfields Passing — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

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Carrying, Receipt, Dribbling & Shooting

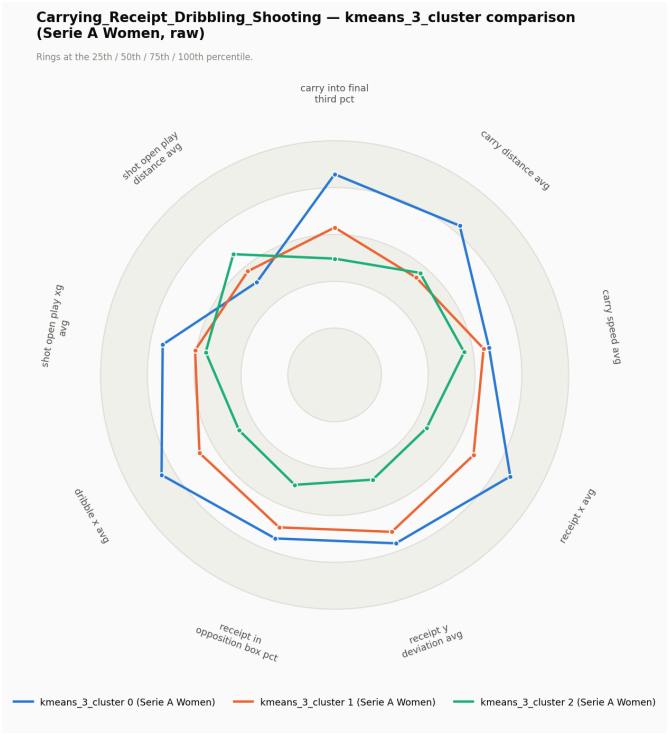


Figure 57: Italy Center Midfields Carrying, Receipt, Dribbling & Shooting — Raw Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

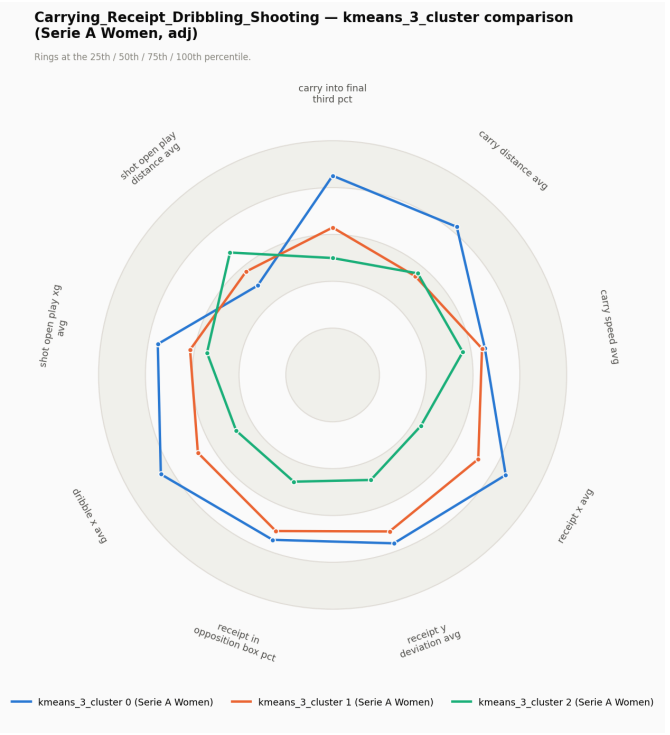


Figure 58: Italy Center Midfields Carrying, Receipt, Dribbling & Shooting — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

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Defending & Vulnerability

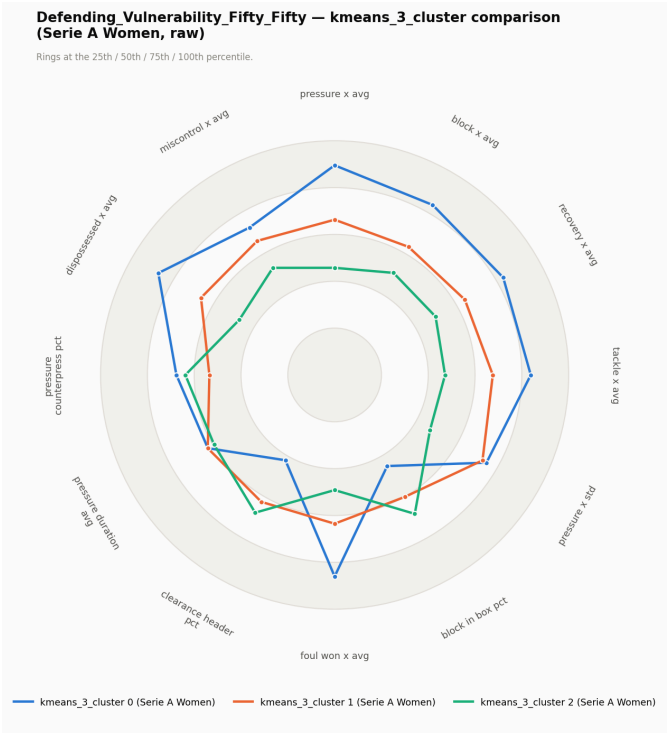


Figure 59: Italy Center Midfields Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Raw Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

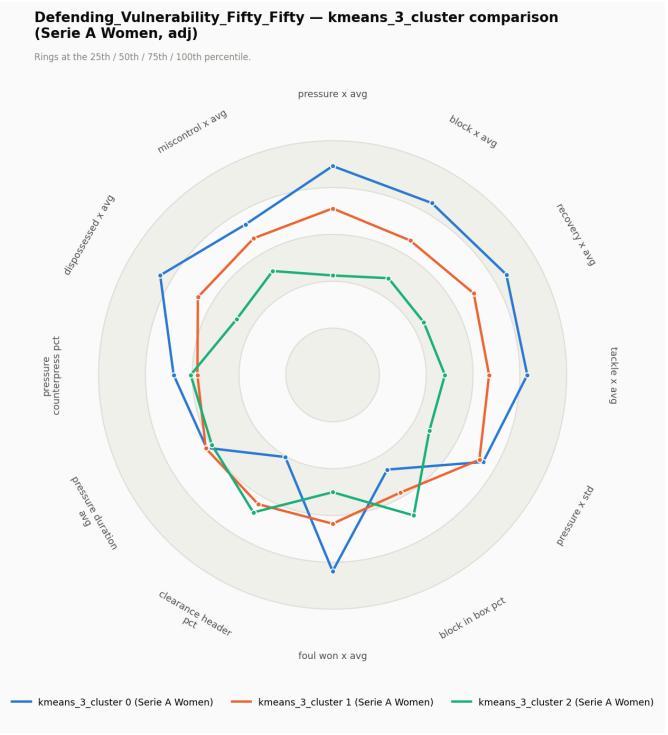


Figure 60: Italy Center Midfields Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters